

INTERNATIONAL news

Meta strikes \$60 billion AI chip deal with AMD

Meta has signed a \$60 billion, five-year deal to purchase AI chips from Advanced Micro Devices, including upcoming MI450 processors, while taking a 10% stake in the chipmaker. The agreement supports Meta's expanding data centre infrastructure and reflects industry efforts to diversify AI chip supply amid surging demand for computing capacity.

Nvidia reports 65% YoY annual revenue increase in FY26

Nvidia reported record fiscal 2026 revenue of \$215.9 billion, up 65%, driven by strong demand for AI and accelerated computing. Fourth-quarter revenue reached \$68.1 billion with net income of \$42.96 billion. The company's data centre business generated \$62.3 billion in quarterly revenue, reflecting surging global demand for AI infrastructure and computing platforms.

GlobalFoundries and Renesas forge pact to tackle chip shortages

GlobalFoundries and Renesas Electronics Corporation have announced a multibillion-dollar expansion of their partnership to boost semiconductor supply for automotive and industrial markets. The deal gives Renesas access to GlobalFoundries' FD-SOI, BCD, and CMOS platforms, with production starting in the US in 2026 before expanding to Germany and Singapore.

SK Hynix to invest \$15 billion in new semiconductor plant in South Korea

SK Hynix will invest about 21.6 trillion won (\$15 billion) to build its first semiconductor fab at the Yongin Semiconductor Cluster by 2030, taking total investment to about 31 trillion won. The facility aims to expand production of advanced chips for AI, data centres, and high-performance computing while strengthening South Korea's semiconductor supply chain.

Nvidia backs US optics manufacturing with \$2 billion investment

Nvidia will invest \$2 billion in Lumentum Holdings Inc. as part of a multiyear partnership to advance optical interconnect technologies for AI data centres. The deal includes multibillion-dollar purchases of laser components and supports a new US fabrication facility, boosting innovation in silicon photonics, manufacturing capacity, and energy-efficient connectivity for large-scale AI infrastructure.

NanoXplore and STMicroelectronics deliver European FPGA for space

NanoXplore and STMicroelectronics have qualified the NG-ULTRA radiation-hardened system-on-chip FPGA for space under the ESCC 9030 standard. Built on ST's 28nm FD-SOI platform, the chip targets low- and medium-earth-orbit satellites, including

about 25% of its 220-230 million global output, up from 36 million in 2024, as supply chains shift from China. Supported by India's PLI scheme, partners including Foxconn, Tata Electronics, and Pegatron produce iPhone 17, 16, and 15 models, while India sales exceed \$9 billion.

Ashok Leyland invests ₹5 billion in new EV battery plant in Tamil Nadu

Ashok Leyland has begun construction of a battery pack manufacturing

facility in Pillaipakkam, near Chennai, Tamil Nadu, with a planned investment of ₹4-5 billion. The plant will produce battery packs for electric commercial vehicles, supporting localisation of EV supply chains and aligning with the state's EV policy and India's mobility and battery storage mission.

Micron begins operations at the \$2.75 billion Sanand facility

Micron Technology has launched its semiconductor assembly and test facil-

ity in Sanand, Gujarat, with a \$2.75 billion investment alongside government partners. The plant will convert DRAM and NAND wafers into finished products for global markets, driven by demand for AI. Micron shipped its first India-made memory modules to Dell Technologies and plans to produce chips at large scale by 2027.

RRP Electronics secures almost 41 hectares for its ₹360 billion Maharashtra project

RRP Electronics Limited has secured

Galileo and Copernicus, delivering higher computing performance, radiation resilience, and lower power for advanced space missions.

Ambiq launches multi-year R&D programme in Singapore

Ambiq has launched a multi-year edge AI research programme in Singapore with support from the Singapore Economic Development Board. The initiative will advance ultra-low-power AI using Ambiq's SPOT technology, expand licensing, and strengthen chip design capabilities for wearables, smart infrastructure, and industrial devices while building local R&D talent and partnerships.

Ayar Labs secures \$500 million to scale co-packaged optics

Ayar Labs has raised \$500 million in a Series E round led by Neuberger Berman, valuing the firm at \$3.75 billion. Backed by investors including AMD, MediaTek, and Nvidia, the funding will scale production of co-packaged optics solutions to overcome data-centre interconnect bottlenecks in AI infrastructure.

Applied Materials agrees to \$252.5 million settlement over export allegations

Applied Materials will pay \$252.5 million to settle export-control violations with the US Bureau of Industry and Security after equipment was shipped via South Korea to China's Semiconductor Manufacturing International Corp. The settlement, the agency's second-largest penalty, mandates compliance audits and warns of export suspension if terms are breached.

R2 Wireless secures \$5 million for US Expansion

Israeli firm R2 Wireless has raised over \$5 million, taking total funding to more than \$13 million, to expand in the United States. Its passive RF monitoring platform, Odin, detects and geolocates signals from drones, mobile, and wireless networks. The technology has seen deployments in Europe and the Middle East, as well as partnerships with defence and infrastructure operators.

Honda restructures EV strategy after \$1.7 billion loss

Honda Motor Co is restructuring its EV operations after a \$1.7 billion write-off and 267 billion yen operating loss, citing US policy changes and EV impairments. From April 2026, Honda R&D will lead automobile and software-defined vehicle development. The company cuts EV spending, focuses on SDVs, expects slower EV growth, and plans to double hybrid sales by 2030.

Foxconn expands beyond consumer electronics

Foxconn, the Taiwanese electronics giant behind production for Apple and Sony, is diversifying with its '3+3+3' strategy. It targets EVs, digital health, robotics, AI, semiconductors, and next-gen communications, supported by smart manufacturing, smart EV, and smart city platforms. The move aims to reduce reliance on consumer electronics, expand industrial influence, and leverage its global manufacturing scale.